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National Health Mission · Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

GESTATIONAL HYPERTENSION & PREECLAMPSIA FIELD PROTOCOL

Standard Treatment Guidelines for Hypertensive Disorders of Pregnancy

DOCUMENT ID: R8-NHM-2026 **EDITION:** Official Field Standard 4.2 **TARGET:** Frontline ASHA Workers

1. Diagnostic Thresholds

• Chronic Hypertension: BP >= 140/90 mmHg recognized before 20 weeks of pregnancy.
• Gestational Hypertension: New onset BP >= 140/90 mmHg recognized after 20 weeks without proteinuria.
• Pre-eclampsia: BP >= 140/90 mmHg accompanied by proteinuria (> 1+ on dipstick) or systemic signs.
• Severe Hypertensive Crisis: Systolic BP >= 160 mmHg or Diastolic BP >= 110 mmHg.

2. Immediate Frontline Stabilization

• Place patient in left lateral tilt position to optimize uteroplacental blood flow.
• Check for impending eclampsia danger signs (headache, epigastric pain, visual scotomas).
• Never administer oral antihypertensives without direct Medical Officer tele-consultation.
• Transport immediately via 108 ambulance to designated First Referral Unit (FRU).

Issuing Authority:
National Health Mission Division
Nirman Bhawan, New Delhi

Field Protocol Verification:
Primary Health Centre / Block MO
Mandatory compliance across sub-centres

ASHA Frontline Desk:
Document all actions in MCP Card
Follow 108 Emergency Protocol